

We have a problem with data—there is too much of it. With increasing bandwidth leading up to the Internet, the amount of data one can come across can easily cross multiple gigabytes per day! Even e-mail solutions provide multiple gigabytes of storage space—it's not just a marketing message anymore: storage space is cheap, data creation is cheaper, and the only thing that will take its toll on us would be making sense of it all. But before we can actually evaluate the multitude of data constantly streaming to our digital doorstep, we need to first find it. Not a small task in itself; in fact, it pretty much defines the old adage of looking for a needle in a haystack. How do you find that one song you feel like listening to in a library of three thousand? How much time will you need to spend looking for that one important e-mail from that person whose name you can't recall—wasn't it sent sometime last week? Search has taken the spotlight in this data-glut. The most famous and successful brands of recent times are all about search—imagine an entire multi-billion dollar industry just revolving around this simple concept of looking for what you need to find.

Not only does Vista offer a comprehensive tool to fashion your search query, it also ensures that you have multiple points of access to this very powerful tool. Let's then take a close look at the search features offered by Vista, and the various elements that go into making Search work.

5.1 Starting With Search

Perhaps to underline the importance of search, you will find the first point of contact with the search tool right at the press of the Start orb; press the Windows key and Search is there, awaiting your command. As soon as you type the first letter of your search query, the Search engine immediately begins compiling a list of Programs; Favorites / Internet History; Files, including documents and media; and Communications, including e-mail, events, tasks,